EXP 3	Survey Report on Emerging Trends in Low-Code Application Development

Aim:

To study and analyse the emerging trends in low-code application development and understand their impact on modern software development.

Theory:

Low-code development lets users build applications with visual interfaces and minimal hand-written code. The major emerging trends are:

- **AI Integration:** AI assistants (such as Zia in Zoho Creator) help create apps from descriptions, suggest fields and add prediction and analytics.
- **Citizen Development:** business users build their own tools with little programming knowledge.
- **Cloud-Native Development:** apps are hosted on the cloud and scale automatically.
- **Business Process Automation:** workflows, approvals, blueprints and schedules automate repetitive tasks.
- **Cross-Platform Apps:** one app runs on web, tablet and mobile.
- **API and Integration:** connections, REST APIs and custom functions link apps with other services.
- **Security and Governance:** role-based access, audit logs and environments.
- **DevOps / Environments:** development, stage and production environments for safe deployment.

Procedure:

1. Study the concept of low-code application development.
2. Identify popular low-code platforms such as Zoho Creator, Microsoft Power Apps, OutSystems and Mendix.
3. Collect information on the latest trends from official documentation and industry reports.
4. Relate each trend to features used in the Hotel Room Booking application.
5. Prepare the survey report and record observations.

Observation:

Trend	Example in the Hotel Booking App
AI integration	Zia AI Models available under Microservices
Process automation	Validation, room-status and email workflows
Cross-platform	Same app viewable in web, tablet and phone modes
Integration	Email notification action, custom Deluge functions
Governance	Roles, permissions and environments
Analytics	Dashboard with KPI panels, charts and gauge

Result:

The survey showed that low-code platforms are rapidly adopting AI, automation, integration, cross-platform delivery and governance features, making them important for fast digital transformation. These trends were identified in the Hotel Room Booking application built on Zoho Creator.